

colours—four text and background colours, six accent colours (for highlighting particular words or graphics), and two hyper-link colours.

To change colours, select **Design tab > Colors**. From the drop-down menu, select the colour scheme you want to use. There are more than 20 inbuilt colour schemes, and a virtually limitless number of combinations to mix and match. Whenever you select a combination, you will get a preview of what your slide will look like.

This rash of choices brings up a problem that has been the bane of many a presentation—atrocious colour combinations that leave the audience with a throbbing headache. Remember that a presentation is not an abstract painting. Some colour combinations like red and black or orange and white are a strict no-no... while using light text on dark backgrounds has been a long time favourite.

Then again, different colours convey different meanings in different cultures and contexts. The inbuilt colour schemes are suitable for most purposes. Alter colours only if you must, when the need is obvious.